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Sue Broughton • YouPremium • YouGaia Nexus
[OnlineGaia Nexus Online](#) 2w • 2 weeks ago • Visible to anyone on or off LinkedIn

Brad, I've been thinking further about your certification load and review time measures because they intersect with something I've been modelling from a slightly different direction.

I agree that we shouldn't turn this into an assessment of whether the individual signer is still capable. But perhaps we can measure whether the conditions under which that capability can be exercised remain sustainable.

In my Coherence Centric Governance work I've been treating load as a first class governance variable. Demand, capacity, utilisation and eventually saturation. Review Time Compression is one of the leading indicators, alongside Declining Contestation or Override Decay.

The interesting thing is that these can begin moving before an error or failed control appears. That may give us something between unlimited signing authority and a fixed cap. A way of forecasting when certification demand is approaching the point where meaningful review can no longer be sustained.

So perhaps the control question becomes not only how much is one signature allowed to cover? but what evidence tells us that the conditions required for that signature to represent genuine judgment are beginning to deteriorate?



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ACCOUNTABILITY CONCENTRATES FASTER THAN THE CAPACITY TO EXERCISE IT.

Sue Broughton put this on one of my posts and I have not stopped turning it over since.

Her observation: as AI takes over more of the underlying work, capital allocation judgment, certification, governance and fiduciary accountability all concentrate upward. The organisation becomes more dependent on the judgment of fewer people. We measure whether the AI is performing, whether the output is certifiable, whether the right person has authority to act. We do not measure whether the humans carrying that accountability are still in a position to exercise it.

Here is the part I think gets missed. What concentrates upward is not only accountability. It is exposure to being wrong.

And the first thing that degrades under that exposure is not analytical sharpness. It is the willingness to be the person who says no.

Saying no lands on one name. Saying yes is spread across everyone who benefited from the speed. Do that a few hundred times and the seat is still held by someone perfectly capable who has quietly stopped using the capability.

Nobody notices, because every individual approval stays defensible. There is no incident. No failed control. Just a person whose name appears on more things they had less time to examine, and a record that reads as evidence that judgment was applied at every step.

Two things you can actually measure.

Certification load. How many items does one person put their name to in a period, and is that number rising. Someone signing more than they can personally examine has already lost the capacity, however good their judgment is. No amount of independent thinking survives volume.

Review time. The gap between a recommendation arriving and its approval, tracked across a population rather than a case, watched over months. A compressing gap against a flat approval rate means the review has become ceremonial and nobody decided to make it so.

The remedy is not an assessment.

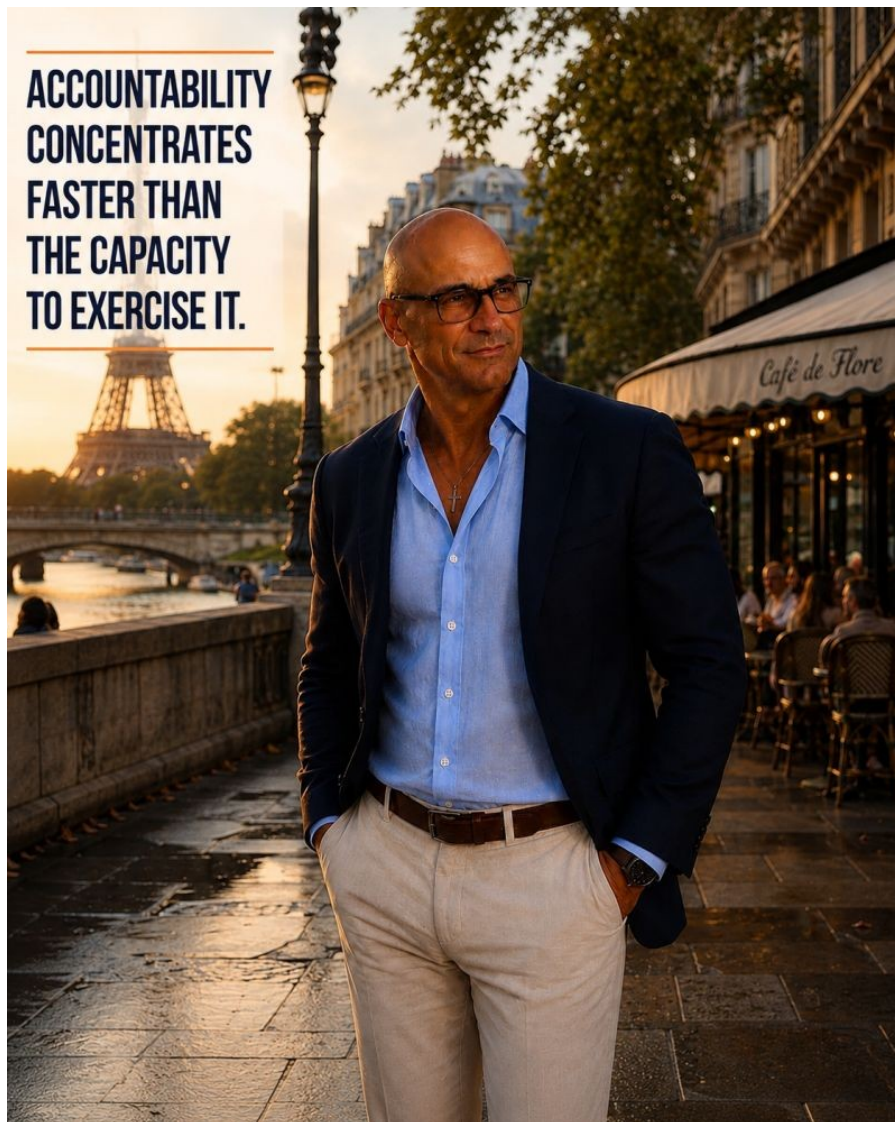
You cannot test whether a signer is still capable. You can limit what one signature is allowed to cover, and require a second name past that line. Which has a real cost, and I would rather say it than have it said to me. A cap slows things down. The person who imposes it looks like the bottleneck, and looks that way immediately, while the thing it prevents never shows up as anything at all. And caps get gamed. Split the item, stay under the threshold, and the second name is never required. So it only works where the threshold is set by exposure rather than by dollar value, and where somebody looks at what is sitting just below the line.

The seat is expanding. That was my argument.

Sue's point is the one that has to sit next to it. A mandate can grow faster than the capacity to carry it, and the growth is visible while the capacity is not.

Brad Wolfe | wolfepacks.com
Sue Broughton

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Frederick Redditt • 1stPremium • 1st

I identify where systems produce the wrong outcome while appearing correct

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Sue, treating load as a first-class governance variable matters because a reviewer may remain capable after the conditions for genuine judgment have deteriorated.

One distinction should remain:

A leading indicator may show that review conditions are becoming inadmissible. It does not establish who may reduce the load, suspend reliance, reset a limit, or permit continuation.

That requires a governed transition:

condition signal → evidentiary qualification → admissibility → valid authority → execution constraint → consequence record.

Brad's companion-series point is essential. Falling review time can mean progress or saturation; declining contestation can mean quality or lost capacity to object. Incoming volume, complexity, and operating conditions must remain part of the evidence.

The question is not only whether the signer remains capable, but whether the conditions supporting the signature still have standing when institutional reliance is about to form.

Within the independently authored Millings Method™, this separates warning from the governed authority to constrain consequence.

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Reply 1 reply 1 Comment on Frederick Redditt's comment



Sue Broughton Premium Author

[Gaia Nexus Online](#)

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Frederick Redditt, yes, I think preserving that distinction is important. A leading indicator can tell us that the conditions supporting meaningful review may be deteriorating, but it cannot by itself confer the authority to alter those conditions or constrain what happens next.

What I find particularly useful in this discussion is that several separate requirements are becoming visible. Detecting deterioration, distinguishing saturation from genuine improvement, and then ensuring there is a governed pathway from that evidence to someone with legitimate authority to intervene.

Brad's point about routing matters here too. If the signal terminates with the person whose conditions it describes, we may have measurement without effective governance. The transition from signal to authorised consequence therefore seems just as important as the quality of the indicator itself. Really useful distinction to add.

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24 impressions



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Sue, the move from whether the signer is capable to whether the conditions remain sustainable is the half I did not have. Each indicator has a benign reading and a malignant one, and from inside the review record they look identical. Contestation declines because nobody has capacity to object, or because the other side learned what gets pushed back and stopped sending it. The comfortable reading is

always available, and it gets taken, because it describes a team doing well.

So they need a companion series from the other side of the gate. Not what the reviewer did, but what arrived: volume, mix, how many items are marginal. Review time falling while the population gets harder is saturation. Falling while it gets cleaner is progress.

Then the harder half, which is the asymmetry the post was about. A leading indicator works only if somebody is obliged to act on it, and these ones indict the person who sees them first. A reviewer whose own numbers say review can no longer be sustained is being asked to volunteer it.

Route them to whoever set the load rather than whoever carries it, and make crossing the line reset the cap rather than open a conversation.

An indicator that arrives at the person it describes is a diary.

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I've been thinking about the same idea from a different angle. Sometimes the conditions fail long before the person does.

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Duluri Saiprem • 2ndVerified • 2nd

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I read this twice and somehow got promoted to the governance committee.

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